

CLINICAL STUDY SERIES

DRUG WORKSHEETS (PRE-FILLED): CRITICAL CARE & EMERGENCY

1 Drug Per Page · Pre-Filled + Write-In · 36 Printable Pages

HOW TO USE

- Print at 100% / "Actual Size" on US Letter paper.
- Work from memory first, then check your notes and textbook.
- Reprint blank copies for each drug class or exam unit.

Norepinephrine

Vasopressors & Inotropes

GENERIC NAME

Norepinephrine

BRAND NAME

Levophed

DRUG CLASS

Vasopressor (Alpha-1 > Beta-1 Agonist)

DRUG FAMILY / SYSTEM

Vasopressors & Inotropes

HIGH-ALERT MEDICATION

☒ Yes ☐ No

BOXED (BLACK BOX) WARNING

☐ Yes ☒ No

ROUTES (CHECK ALL THAT APPLY)

☐ PO ☐ IV ☐ IM ☐ SubQ ☐ SL ☐ Topical ☐ Inhaled ☐ Other

THERAPEUTIC USES

Septic shock (first-line), severe hypotension

MECHANISM OF ACTION

Alpha-1 vasoconstriction with some beta-1 inotropy

ADVERSE / SIDE EFFECTS

Tissue ischemia, extravasation necrosis, arrhythmias

NURSING CONSIDERATIONS

Central line preferred. Titrate to MAP 65+. Extravasation: phentolamine.

CONTRAINDICATIONS

PATIENT EDUCATION

MY NOTES & MEMORY TRICKS

Epinephrine

Vasopressors & Inotropes

GENERIC NAME

Epinephrine

BRAND NAME

DRUG CLASS

Vasopressor / Inotrope (Alpha + Beta Agonist)

DRUG FAMILY / SYSTEM

Vasopressors & Inotropes

HIGH-ALERT MEDICATION

☒ Yes ☐ No

BOXED (BLACK BOX) WARNING

☐ Yes ☒ No

ROUTES (CHECK ALL THAT APPLY)

☐ PO ☐ IV ☐ IM ☐ SubQ ☐ SL ☐ Topical ☐ Inhaled ☐ Other

THERAPEUTIC USES

Cardiac arrest, anaphylaxis, shock

MECHANISM OF ACTION

Alpha vasoconstriction plus beta-1 inotropy and beta-2 bronchodilation

ADVERSE / SIDE EFFECTS

Tachyarrhythmias, hypertension, hyperglycemia, lactic acidosis

NURSING CONSIDERATIONS

Arrest: 1 mg IV every 3-5 min. Anaphylaxis: IM in the outer thigh (1 mg/mL).

CONTRAINDICATIONS

PATIENT EDUCATION

MY NOTES & MEMORY TRICKS

Vasopressin

Vasopressors & Inotropes

GENERIC NAME

Vasopressin

BRAND NAME

DRUG CLASS

Vasopressor (V1 Agonist)

DRUG FAMILY / SYSTEM

Vasopressors & Inotropes

HIGH-ALERT MEDICATION

☒ Yes ☐ No

BOXED (BLACK BOX) WARNING

☐ Yes ☒ No

ROUTES (CHECK ALL THAT APPLY)

☐ PO ☐ IV ☐ IM ☐ SubQ ☐ SL ☐ Topical ☐ Inhaled ☐ Other

THERAPEUTIC USES

Septic shock (added to norepinephrine)

MECHANISM OF ACTION

V1 receptor vasoconstriction, independent of catecholamines

ADVERSE / SIDE EFFECTS

Digital and mesenteric ischemia, hyponatremia

NURSING CONSIDERATIONS

Usually a fixed dose, not titrated. Spares norepinephrine.

CONTRAINDICATIONS

PATIENT EDUCATION

MY NOTES & MEMORY TRICKS

Phenylephrine

Vasopressors & Inotropes

GENERIC NAME

Phenylephrine

BRAND NAME

DRUG CLASS

Vasopressor (Pure Alpha-1 Agonist)

DRUG FAMILY / SYSTEM

Vasopressors & Inotropes

HIGH-ALERT MEDICATION

☒ Yes ☐ No

BOXED (BLACK BOX) WARNING

☐ Yes ☒ No

ROUTES (CHECK ALL THAT APPLY)

☐ PO ☐ IV ☐ IM ☐ SubQ ☐ SL ☐ Topical ☐ Inhaled ☐ Other

THERAPEUTIC USES

Hypotension (especially during anesthesia)

MECHANISM OF ACTION

Alpha-1 vasoconstriction; no beta effect

ADVERSE / SIDE EFFECTS

Reflex bradycardia, reduced cardiac output, ischemia

NURSING CONSIDERATIONS

Useful when heart rate is already fast. Can run peripherally short-term.

CONTRAINDICATIONS

PATIENT EDUCATION

MY NOTES & MEMORY TRICKS

Dopamine

GENERIC NAME

Dopamine

BRAND NAME

DRUG CLASS

Vasopressor / Inotrope
(Dose-Dependent)

DRUG FAMILY / SYSTEM

Vasopressors & Inotropes

HIGH-ALERT MEDICATION

☒ Yes ☐ No

BOXED (BLACK BOX) WARNING

☐ Yes ☒ No

ROUTES (CHECK ALL THAT APPLY)

☐ PO ☐ IV ☐ IM ☐ SubQ ☐ SL ☐ Topical ☐ Inhaled ☐ Other

THERAPEUTIC USES

Shock, symptomatic bradycardia

MECHANISM OF ACTION

Low dose: dopamine receptors; mid: beta-1; high: alpha-1

ADVERSE / SIDE EFFECTS

Tachyarrhythmias, extravasation necrosis

NURSING CONSIDERATIONS

More arrhythmias than norepinephrine in septic shock.

CONTRAINDICATIONS

PATIENT EDUCATION

MY NOTES & MEMORY TRICKS

Dobutamine

Vasopressors & Inotropes

GENERIC NAME

Dobutamine

BRAND NAME

DRUG CLASS

Inotrope (Beta-1 Agonist)

DRUG FAMILY / SYSTEM

Vasopressors & Inotropes

HIGH-ALERT MEDICATION

☒ Yes ☐ No

BOXED (BLACK BOX) WARNING

☐ Yes ☒ No

ROUTES (CHECK ALL THAT APPLY)

☐ PO ☐ IV ☐ IM ☐ SubQ ☐ SL ☐ Topical ☐ Inhaled ☐ Other

THERAPEUTIC USES

Cardiogenic shock, acute decompensated heart failure

MECHANISM OF ACTION

Increases contractility with mild vasodilation

ADVERSE / SIDE EFFECTS

Tachycardia, arrhythmias, hypotension

NURSING CONSIDERATIONS

Not a vasopressor: BP can drop. Monitor ECG and BP closely.

CONTRAINDICATIONS

PATIENT EDUCATION

MY NOTES & MEMORY TRICKS

Milrinone

Vasopressors & Inotropes

GENERIC NAME	BRAND NAME	DRUG CLASS
Milrinone		Inotrope (PDE-3 Inhibitor)
DRUG FAMILY / SYSTEM	HIGH-ALERT MEDICATION	BOXED (BLACK BOX) WARNING
Vasopressors & Inotropes	☒ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☒ No
ROUTES (CHECK ALL THAT APPLY)		
☐ PO ☐ IV ☐ IM ☐ SubQ ☐ SL ☐ Topical ☐ Inhaled ☐ Other		

THERAPEUTIC USES

Acute decompensated heart failure, low cardiac output

MECHANISM OF ACTION

Raises cAMP: stronger contraction plus vasodilation ('inodilator')

ADVERSE / SIDE EFFECTS

Hypotension, arrhythmias

NURSING CONSIDERATIONS

Renally cleared; reduce dose in kidney disease.

CONTRAINDICATIONS

PATIENT EDUCATION

MY NOTES & MEMORY TRICKS

Propofol

GENERIC NAME	BRAND NAME	DRUG CLASS
Propofol	Diprivan	Sedative-Hypnotic (IV Anesthetic)
DRUG FAMILY / SYSTEM	HIGH-ALERT MEDICATION	BOXED (BLACK BOX) WARNING
Sedation & Analgesia	☒ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☒ No

ROUTES (CHECK ALL THAT APPLY)

☐ PO

☐ IV

☐ IM

☐ SubQ

☐ SL

☐ Topical

☐ Inhaled

☐ Other

THERAPEUTIC USES

ICU sedation, anesthesia induction

MECHANISM OF ACTION

Enhances GABA-A activity

ADVERSE / SIDE EFFECTS

Hypotension, respiratory depression, high triglycerides, propofol infusion syndrome

NURSING CONSIDERATIONS

Lipid emulsion: strict aseptic technique; change tubing per policy.

CONTRAINDICATIONS

PATIENT EDUCATION

MY NOTES & MEMORY TRICKS

Dexmedetomidine

Sedation & Analgesia

GENERIC NAME

Dexmedetomidine

BRAND NAME

Precedex

DRUG CLASS

Sedative (Central Alpha-2 Agonist)

DRUG FAMILY / SYSTEM

Sedation & Analgesia

HIGH-ALERT MEDICATION

☒ Yes ☐ No

BOXED (BLACK BOX) WARNING

☐ Yes ☒ No

ROUTES (CHECK ALL THAT APPLY)

☐ PO ☐ IV ☐ IM ☐ SubQ ☐ SL ☐ Topical ☐ Inhaled ☐ Other

THERAPEUTIC USES

ICU and procedural sedation

MECHANISM OF ACTION

Alpha-2 agonism reduces sympathetic output

ADVERSE / SIDE EFFECTS

Bradycardia, hypotension

NURSING CONSIDERATIONS

Minimal respiratory depression; patient stays arousable.

CONTRAINDICATIONS

PATIENT EDUCATION

MY NOTES & MEMORY TRICKS

Midazolam (IV)

Sedation & Analgesia

GENERIC NAME	BRAND NAME	DRUG CLASS
Midazolam (IV)		Benzodiazepine (IV Sedation)
DRUG FAMILY / SYSTEM	HIGH-ALERT MEDICATION	BOXED (BLACK BOX) WARNING
Sedation & Analgesia	☒ Yes ☐ No	☒ Yes ☐ No

ROUTES (CHECK ALL THAT APPLY)

☐ PO

☐ IV

☐ IM

☐ SubQ

☐ SL

☐ Topical

☐ Inhaled

☐ Other

THERAPEUTIC USES

Procedural and ICU sedation, status epilepticus

MECHANISM OF ACTION

Enhances GABA-A activity

ADVERSE / SIDE EFFECTS

Respiratory depression, hypotension, delirium, accumulation

NURSING CONSIDERATIONS

Accumulates in obesity and kidney failure.
Reversal: flumazenil.

CONTRAINDICATIONS

PATIENT EDUCATION

MY NOTES & MEMORY TRICKS

Ketamine

GENERIC NAME

Ketamine

BRAND NAME

DRUG CLASS

Dissociative Anesthetic (NMDA Antagonist)

DRUG FAMILY / SYSTEM

Sedation & Analgesia

HIGH-ALERT MEDICATION

☒ Yes ☐ No

BOXED (BLACK BOX) WARNING

☐ Yes ☒ No

ROUTES (CHECK ALL THAT APPLY)

☐ PO ☐ IV ☐ IM ☐ SubQ ☐ SL ☐ Topical ☐ Inhaled ☐ Other

THERAPEUTIC USES

RSI induction, analgesia, procedural sedation

MECHANISM OF ACTION

Blocks NMDA receptors

ADVERSE / SIDE EFFECTS

Emergence reactions, hypertension, tachycardia, increased secretions

NURSING CONSIDERATIONS

Preserves airway reflexes and blood pressure.

CONTRAINDICATIONS

PATIENT EDUCATION

MY NOTES & MEMORY TRICKS

Fentanyl (IV)

Sedation & Analgesia

GENERIC NAME	BRAND NAME	DRUG CLASS
Fentanyl (IV)		Opioid Analgesic (IV)
DRUG FAMILY / SYSTEM	HIGH-ALERT MEDICATION	BOXED (BLACK BOX) WARNING
Sedation & Analgesia	☒ Yes ☐ No	☒ Yes ☐ No
ROUTES (CHECK ALL THAT APPLY)		
☐ PO ☐ IV ☐ IM ☐ SubQ ☐ SL ☐ Topical ☐ Inhaled ☐ Other		

THERAPEUTIC USES

ICU analgesia, procedural pain

MECHANISM OF ACTION

Mu-opioid receptor agonist

ADVERSE / SIDE EFFECTS

Respiratory depression, chest wall rigidity (rapid push), bradycardia

NURSING CONSIDERATIONS

Analgesia-first sedation. Reversal: naloxone.

CONTRAINDICATIONS

PATIENT EDUCATION

MY NOTES & MEMORY TRICKS

Etomidate

GENERIC NAME

Etomidate

BRAND NAME

DRUG CLASS

Sedative-Hypnotic (Induction Agent)

DRUG FAMILY / SYSTEM

Sedation & Analgesia

HIGH-ALERT MEDICATION

☒ Yes ☐ No

BOXED (BLACK BOX) WARNING

☐ Yes ☒ No

ROUTES (CHECK ALL THAT APPLY)

☐ PO ☐ IV ☐ IM ☐ SubQ ☐ SL ☐ Topical ☐ Inhaled ☐ Other

THERAPEUTIC USES

Rapid sequence intubation (RSI) induction

MECHANISM OF ACTION

Enhances GABA-A activity

ADVERSE / SIDE EFFECTS

Adrenal suppression, myoclonus, nausea/vomiting

NURSING CONSIDERATIONS

Hemodynamically stable. Single induction dose only.

CONTRAINDICATIONS

PATIENT EDUCATION

MY NOTES & MEMORY TRICKS

Succinylcholine

Neuromuscular Blockers

GENERIC NAME

Succinylcholine

BRAND NAME

DRUG CLASS

Depolarizing Neuromuscular Blocker

DRUG FAMILY / SYSTEM

Neuromuscular Blockers

HIGH-ALERT MEDICATION

☒ Yes ☐ No

BOXED (BLACK BOX) WARNING

☒ Yes ☐ No

ROUTES (CHECK ALL THAT APPLY)

☐ PO ☐ IV ☐ IM ☐ SubQ ☐ SL ☐ Topical ☐ Inhaled ☐ Other

THERAPEUTIC USES

RSI paralysis

MECHANISM OF ACTION

Persistent depolarization at the nicotinic receptor

ADVERSE / SIDE EFFECTS

Hyperkalemia, malignant hyperthermia, bradycardia, fasciculations

NURSING CONSIDERATIONS

Avoid with hyperkalemia, older burns/crush injury, neuromuscular disease. Sedate first.

CONTRAINDICATIONS

PATIENT EDUCATION

MY NOTES & MEMORY TRICKS

Rocuronium

Neuromuscular Blockers

GENERIC NAME	BRAND NAME	DRUG CLASS
Rocuronium		Nondepolarizing Neuromuscular Blocker
DRUG FAMILY / SYSTEM	HIGH-ALERT MEDICATION	BOXED (BLACK BOX) WARNING
Neuromuscular Blockers	☒ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☒ No

ROUTES (CHECK ALL THAT APPLY)

☐ PO☐ IV☐ IM☐ SubQ☐ SL☐ Topical☐ Inhaled☐ Other

THERAPEUTIC USES	NURSING CONSIDERATIONS
RSI, intubation, mechanical ventilation	No sedation or pain relief: always sedate. Reversal: sugammadex.

MECHANISM OF ACTION

Competitively blocks acetylcholine at nicotinic receptors

ADVERSE / SIDE EFFECTS

Prolonged paralysis

CONTRAINDICATIONS

PATIENT EDUCATION

MY NOTES & MEMORY TRICKS

Vecuronium

Neuromuscular Blockers

GENERIC NAME

Vecuronium

BRAND NAME

DRUG CLASS

Nondepolarizing Neuromuscular Blocker

DRUG FAMILY / SYSTEM

Neuromuscular Blockers

HIGH-ALERT MEDICATION

☒ Yes ☐ No

BOXED (BLACK BOX) WARNING

☐ Yes ☒ No

ROUTES (CHECK ALL THAT APPLY)

☐ PO ☐ IV ☐ IM ☐ SubQ ☐ SL ☐ Topical ☐ Inhaled ☐ Other

THERAPEUTIC USES

Intubation, mechanical ventilation

MECHANISM OF ACTION

Competitively blocks acetylcholine at nicotinic receptors

ADVERSE / SIDE EFFECTS

Prolonged paralysis, especially in liver disease

NURSING CONSIDERATIONS

Powder must be reconstituted. Reversal: sugammadex or neostigmine.

CONTRAINDICATIONS

PATIENT EDUCATION

MY NOTES & MEMORY TRICKS

Cisatracurium

Neuromuscular Blockers

GENERIC NAME

Cisatracurium

BRAND NAME

DRUG CLASS

Nondepolarizing Neuromuscular Blocker

DRUG FAMILY / SYSTEM

Neuromuscular Blockers

HIGH-ALERT MEDICATION

☒ Yes ☐ No

BOXED (BLACK BOX) WARNING

☐ Yes ☒ No

ROUTES (CHECK ALL THAT APPLY)

☐ PO ☐ IV ☐ IM ☐ SubQ ☐ SL ☐ Topical ☐ Inhaled ☐ Other

THERAPEUTIC USES

Paralysis in ICU (e.g., ARDS)

MECHANISM OF ACTION

Competitively blocks acetylcholine at nicotinic receptors

ADVERSE / SIDE EFFECTS

Prolonged paralysis, bradycardia

NURSING CONSIDERATIONS

Organ-independent (Hofmann) elimination: good choice in liver or kidney failure.

CONTRAINDICATIONS

PATIENT EDUCATION

MY NOTES & MEMORY TRICKS

Adenosine

GENERIC NAME

Adenosine

BRAND NAME

DRUG CLASS

Class V Antiarrhythmic

DRUG FAMILY / SYSTEM

ACLS & Antiarrhythmics

HIGH-ALERT MEDICATION

☐ Yes ☒ No

BOXED (BLACK BOX) WARNING

☐ Yes ☒ No

ROUTES (CHECK ALL THAT APPLY)

☐ PO ☐ IV ☐ IM ☐ SubQ ☐ SL ☐ Topical ☐ Inhaled ☐ Other

THERAPEUTIC USES

Stable narrow-complex SVT

MECHANISM OF ACTION

Briefly blocks AV node conduction

ADVERSE / SIDE EFFECTS

Brief asystole, flushing, chest pressure, dyspnea

NURSING CONSIDERATIONS

6 mg rapid IV push with flush, then 12 mg. Use the port closest to the heart.

CONTRAINDICATIONS

PATIENT EDUCATION

MY NOTES & MEMORY TRICKS

Amiodarone (IV)

ACLS & Antiarrhythmics

GENERIC NAME

Amiodarone (IV)

BRAND NAME

DRUG CLASS

Class III Antiarrhythmic

DRUG FAMILY / SYSTEM

ACLS & Antiarrhythmics

HIGH-ALERT MEDICATION

☒ Yes ☐ No

BOXED (BLACK BOX) WARNING

☐ Yes ☒ No

ROUTES (CHECK ALL THAT APPLY)

☐ PO ☐ IV ☐ IM ☐ SubQ ☐ SL ☐ Topical ☐ Inhaled ☐ Other

THERAPEUTIC USES

VF/pulseless VT, stable VT, AFib

MECHANISM OF ACTION

Blocks potassium channels, prolonging repolarization

ADVERSE / SIDE EFFECTS

Hypotension, bradycardia, phlebitis

NURSING CONSIDERATIONS

Arrest: 300 mg IV, then 150 mg. Long infusions: central line if possible.

CONTRAINDICATIONS

PATIENT EDUCATION

MY NOTES & MEMORY TRICKS

Lidocaine (IV)

ACLS & Antiarrhythmics

GENERIC NAME

Lidocaine (IV)

BRAND NAME

DRUG CLASS

Class IB Antiarrhythmic

DRUG FAMILY / SYSTEM

ACLS & Antiarrhythmics

HIGH-ALERT MEDICATION

☐ Yes ☒ No

BOXED (BLACK BOX) WARNING

☐ Yes ☒ No

ROUTES (CHECK ALL THAT APPLY)

☐ PO ☐ IV ☐ IM ☐ SubQ ☐ SL ☐ Topical ☐ Inhaled ☐ Other

THERAPEUTIC USES

VF/pulseless VT (alternative to amiodarone)

MECHANISM OF ACTION

Blocks sodium channels in ventricular tissue

ADVERSE / SIDE EFFECTS

CNS toxicity (confusion, seizures), bradycardia

NURSING CONSIDERATIONS

Early toxicity: perioral numbness, tinnitus, metallic taste.

CONTRAINDICATIONS

PATIENT EDUCATION

MY NOTES & MEMORY TRICKS

Atropine

GENERIC NAME

Atropine

BRAND NAME

DRUG CLASS

Anticholinergic (Antimuscarinic)

DRUG FAMILY / SYSTEM

ACLS & Antiarrhythmics

HIGH-ALERT MEDICATION

☐ Yes ☒ No

BOXED (BLACK BOX) WARNING

☐ Yes ☒ No

ROUTES (CHECK ALL THAT APPLY)

☐ PO ☐ IV ☐ IM ☐ SubQ ☐ SL ☐ Topical ☐ Inhaled ☐ Other

THERAPEUTIC USES

Symptomatic bradycardia, organophosphate poisoning

MECHANISM OF ACTION

Blocks vagal (muscarinic) effects on the heart

ADVERSE / SIDE EFFECTS

Tachycardia, dry mouth, urinary retention, delirium

NURSING CONSIDERATIONS

Bradycardia: 1 mg IV every 3-5 min, max 3 mg.

CONTRAINDICATIONS

PATIENT EDUCATION

MY NOTES & MEMORY TRICKS

Procainamide

ACLS & Antiarrhythmics

GENERIC NAME

Procainamide

BRAND NAME

DRUG CLASS

Class IA Antiarrhythmic

DRUG FAMILY / SYSTEM

ACLS & Antiarrhythmics

HIGH-ALERT MEDICATION

☐ Yes ☒ No

BOXED (BLACK BOX) WARNING

☒ Yes ☐ No

ROUTES (CHECK ALL THAT APPLY)

☐ PO ☐ IV ☐ IM ☐ SubQ ☐ SL ☐ Topical ☐ Inhaled ☐ Other

THERAPEUTIC USES

Stable wide-complex tachycardia, AFib with WPW

MECHANISM OF ACTION

Blocks sodium channels, slowing conduction

ADVERSE / SIDE EFFECTS

Hypotension, QT prolongation, lupus-like syndrome

NURSING CONSIDERATIONS

Stop if QRS widens over 50%, hypotension, or arrhythmia is suppressed.

CONTRAINDICATIONS

PATIENT EDUCATION

MY NOTES & MEMORY TRICKS

Magnesium Sulfate

ACLS & Antiarrhythmics

GENERIC NAME

Magnesium Sulfate

BRAND NAME

DRUG CLASS

Electrolyte / Antiarrhythmic

DRUG FAMILY / SYSTEM

ACLS & Antiarrhythmics

HIGH-ALERT MEDICATION

☒ Yes ☐ No

BOXED (BLACK BOX) WARNING

☐ Yes ☒ No

ROUTES (CHECK ALL THAT APPLY)

☐ PO ☐ IV ☐ IM ☐ SubQ ☐ SL ☐ Topical ☐ Inhaled ☐ Other

THERAPEUTIC USES

Torsades de pointes, eclampsia seizures, low magnesium, severe asthma

MECHANISM OF ACTION

Stabilizes cardiac and neuronal membranes

ADVERSE / SIDE EFFECTS

Flushing, hypotension, lost reflexes, respiratory depression

NURSING CONSIDERATIONS

Monitor reflexes, RR, urine output. Antidote: calcium gluconate.

CONTRAINDICATIONS

PATIENT EDUCATION

MY NOTES & MEMORY TRICKS

Nicardipine (IV)

IV Antihypertensives

GENERIC NAME	BRAND NAME	DRUG CLASS
Nicardipine (IV)		IV Calcium Channel Blocker (DHP)
DRUG FAMILY / SYSTEM	HIGH-ALERT MEDICATION	BOXED (BLACK BOX) WARNING
IV Antihypertensives	☐ Yes ☒ No	☐ Yes ☒ No

ROUTES (CHECK ALL THAT APPLY)

☐ PO

☐ IV

☐ IM

☐ SubQ

☐ SL

☐ Topical

☐ Inhaled

☐ Other

THERAPEUTIC USES

Hypertensive emergency, stroke BP control

MECHANISM OF ACTION

Relaxes arterial smooth muscle

ADVERSE / SIDE EFFECTS

Headache, reflex tachycardia, hypotension

NURSING CONSIDERATIONS

Titratable drip. Rotate peripheral IV sites to limit phlebitis.

CONTRAINDICATIONS

PATIENT EDUCATION

MY NOTES & MEMORY TRICKS

Clevidipine

IV Antihypertensives

GENERIC NAME

Clevidipine

BRAND NAME

Cleviprex

DRUG CLASS

IV Calcium Channel Blocker
(Ultra-Short)

DRUG FAMILY / SYSTEM

IV Antihypertensives

HIGH-ALERT MEDICATION

☐ Yes ☒ No

BOXED (BLACK BOX) WARNING

☐ Yes ☒ No

ROUTES (CHECK ALL THAT APPLY)

☐ PO ☐ IV ☐ IM ☐ SubQ ☐ SL ☐ Topical ☐ Inhaled ☐ Other

THERAPEUTIC USES

Perioperative and emergency hypertension

MECHANISM OF ACTION

Relaxes arterial smooth muscle

ADVERSE / SIDE EFFECTS

Headache, reflex tachycardia, hypotension

NURSING CONSIDERATIONS

Lipid emulsion: avoid with soy or egg allergy.
Works in minutes.

CONTRAINDICATIONS

PATIENT EDUCATION

MY NOTES & MEMORY TRICKS

Nitroprusside

IV Antihypertensives

GENERIC NAME

Nitroprusside

BRAND NAME

DRUG CLASS

Direct Vasodilator (IV)

DRUG FAMILY / SYSTEM

IV Antihypertensives

HIGH-ALERT MEDICATION

☒ Yes ☐ No

BOXED (BLACK BOX) WARNING

☒ Yes ☐ No

ROUTES (CHECK ALL THAT APPLY)

☐ PO ☐ IV ☐ IM ☐ SubQ ☐ SL ☐ Topical ☐ Inhaled ☐ Other

THERAPEUTIC USES

Hypertensive emergency, acute heart failure

MECHANISM OF ACTION

Releases nitric oxide, dilating arteries and veins

ADVERSE / SIDE EFFECTS

Profound hypotension, cyanide/thiocyanate toxicity

NURSING CONSIDERATIONS

Protect from light. Arterial line BP monitoring.

CONTRAINDICATIONS

PATIENT EDUCATION

MY NOTES & MEMORY TRICKS

Nitroglycerin (IV)

IV Antihypertensives

GENERIC NAME

Nitroglycerin (IV)

BRAND NAME

DRUG CLASS

Nitrate (IV)

DRUG FAMILY / SYSTEM

IV Antihypertensives

HIGH-ALERT MEDICATION

☐ Yes ☒ No

BOXED (BLACK BOX) WARNING

☐ Yes ☒ No

ROUTES (CHECK ALL THAT APPLY)

☐ PO ☐ IV ☐ IM ☐ SubQ ☐ SL ☐ Topical ☐ Inhaled ☐ Other

THERAPEUTIC USES

Acute coronary syndrome, pulmonary edema, hypertension

MECHANISM OF ACTION

Releases nitric oxide, mainly dilating veins

ADVERSE / SIDE EFFECTS

Headache, hypotension, reflex tachycardia

NURSING CONSIDERATIONS

Avoid with recent PDE-5 inhibitor use or right ventricular infarct.

CONTRAINDICATIONS

PATIENT EDUCATION

MY NOTES & MEMORY TRICKS

Sodium Bicarbonate

Emergency & Rescue

GENERIC NAME

Sodium Bicarbonate

BRAND NAME

DRUG CLASS

Alkalinizing Agent

DRUG FAMILY / SYSTEM

Emergency & Rescue

HIGH-ALERT MEDICATION

☐ Yes ☒ No

BOXED (BLACK BOX) WARNING

☐ Yes ☒ No

ROUTES (CHECK ALL THAT APPLY)

☐ PO ☐ IV ☐ IM ☐ SubQ ☐ SL ☐ Topical ☐ Inhaled ☐ Other

THERAPEUTIC USES

Severe metabolic acidosis, TCA overdose, hyperkalemia

MECHANISM OF ACTION

Buffers acid, raising blood pH

ADVERSE / SIDE EFFECTS

Metabolic alkalosis, hypernatremia, fluid overload, extravasation injury

NURSING CONSIDERATIONS

Not routine in cardiac arrest. Flush between bicarbonate and calcium (precipitates).

CONTRAINDICATIONS

PATIENT EDUCATION

MY NOTES & MEMORY TRICKS

Calcium Chloride

Emergency & Rescue

GENERIC NAME	BRAND NAME	DRUG CLASS
Calcium Chloride		Electrolyte (IV Calcium)
DRUG FAMILY / SYSTEM	HIGH-ALERT MEDICATION	BOXED (BLACK BOX) WARNING
Emergency & Rescue	☐ Yes ☒ No	☐ Yes ☒ No

ROUTES (CHECK ALL THAT APPLY)

☐ PO

☐ IV

☐ IM

☐ SubQ

☐ SL

☐ Topical

☐ Inhaled

☐ Other

THERAPEUTIC USES

Hyperkalemia (cardiac protection), low calcium, CCB overdose

MECHANISM OF ACTION

Stabilizes the cardiac membrane; replaces calcium

ADVERSE / SIDE EFFECTS

Bradycardia, extravasation necrosis, hypercalcemia

NURSING CONSIDERATIONS

About 3 times the calcium of calcium gluconate. Central line preferred.

CONTRAINDICATIONS

PATIENT EDUCATION

MY NOTES & MEMORY TRICKS

Hypertonic Saline (3%)

Emergency & Rescue

GENERIC NAME	BRAND NAME	DRUG CLASS
Hypertonic Saline (3%)		Hyperosmolar Agent
DRUG FAMILY / SYSTEM	HIGH-ALERT MEDICATION	BOXED (BLACK BOX) WARNING
Emergency & Rescue	☒ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☒ No

ROUTES (CHECK ALL THAT APPLY)

☐ PO

☐ IV

☐ IM

☐ SubQ

☐ SL

☐ Topical

☐ Inhaled

☐ Other

THERAPEUTIC USES

Raised intracranial pressure, severe symptomatic hyponatremia

MECHANISM OF ACTION

Draws water out of brain cells

ADVERSE / SIDE EFFECTS

Hypernatremia, fluid overload, osmotic demyelination if too fast

NURSING CONSIDERATIONS

Frequent sodium checks. Chronic hyponatremia: correct slowly (limit per 24 hr).

CONTRAINDICATIONS

PATIENT EDUCATION

MY NOTES & MEMORY TRICKS

Insulin Infusion (Regular)

Emergency & Rescue

GENERIC NAME

Insulin Infusion (Regular)

BRAND NAME

DRUG CLASS

Short-Acting Insulin (IV)

DRUG FAMILY / SYSTEM

Emergency & Rescue

HIGH-ALERT MEDICATION

☒ Yes ☐ No

BOXED (BLACK BOX) WARNING

☐ Yes ☒ No

ROUTES (CHECK ALL THAT APPLY)

☐ PO ☐ IV ☐ IM ☐ SubQ ☐ SL ☐ Topical ☐ Inhaled ☐ Other

THERAPEUTIC USES

DKA, HHS, ICU hyperglycemia

MECHANISM OF ACTION

Drives glucose and potassium into cells

ADVERSE / SIDE EFFECTS

Hypoglycemia, hypokalemia

NURSING CONSIDERATIONS

In DKA, confirm K+ is at least 3.3 before starting. Hourly glucose checks.

CONTRAINDICATIONS

PATIENT EDUCATION

MY NOTES & MEMORY TRICKS

Potassium Chloride (IV)

Emergency & Rescue

GENERIC NAME Potassium Chloride (IV)	BRAND NAME 	DRUG CLASS Electrolyte (IV Potassium)
DRUG FAMILY / SYSTEM Emergency & Rescue	HIGH-ALERT MEDICATION ☒ Yes ☐ No	BOXED (BLACK BOX) WARNING ☐ Yes ☒ No

ROUTES (CHECK ALL THAT APPLY)

☐ PO ☐ IV ☐ IM ☐ SubQ ☐ SL ☐ Topical ☐ Inhaled ☐ Other

THERAPEUTIC USES Hypokalemia	NURSING CONSIDERATIONS NEVER IV push. Always diluted and on a pump at a policy-limited rate.
MECHANISM OF ACTION Replaces potassium	CONTRAINDICATIONS
ADVERSE / SIDE EFFECTS Hyperkalemia, arrhythmias, IV-site pain and phlebitis	PATIENT EDUCATION

MY NOTES & MEMORY TRICKS

Tranexamic Acid (TXA)

Emergency & Rescue

GENERIC NAME

Tranexamic Acid (TXA)

BRAND NAME

DRUG CLASS

Antifibrinolytic

DRUG FAMILY / SYSTEM

Emergency & Rescue

HIGH-ALERT MEDICATION

☐ Yes ☒ No

BOXED (BLACK BOX) WARNING

☐ Yes ☒ No

ROUTES (CHECK ALL THAT APPLY)

☐ PO ☐ IV ☐ IM ☐ SubQ ☐ SL ☐ Topical ☐ Inhaled ☐ Other

THERAPEUTIC USES

Trauma bleeding, postpartum hemorrhage, surgical bleeding

MECHANISM OF ACTION

Blocks plasminogen activation, stabilizing clots

ADVERSE / SIDE EFFECTS

Thrombosis, seizures (high doses), hypotension if pushed fast

NURSING CONSIDERATIONS

Trauma: give within 3 hours of injury.

CONTRAINDICATIONS

PATIENT EDUCATION

MY NOTES & MEMORY TRICKS

4-Factor PCC

Emergency & Rescue

GENERIC NAME

4-Factor PCC

BRAND NAME

Kcentra

DRUG CLASS

Prothrombin Complex Concentrate

DRUG FAMILY / SYSTEM

Emergency & Rescue

HIGH-ALERT MEDICATION

☒ Yes ☐ No

BOXED (BLACK BOX) WARNING

☒ Yes ☐ No

ROUTES (CHECK ALL THAT APPLY)

☐ PO ☐ IV ☐ IM ☐ SubQ ☐ SL ☐ Topical ☐ Inhaled ☐ Other

THERAPEUTIC USES

Urgent warfarin reversal with major bleeding

MECHANISM OF ACTION

Replaces factors II, VII, IX, X and proteins C and S

ADVERSE / SIDE EFFECTS

Thrombosis, stroke

NURSING CONSIDERATIONS

Give with IV vitamin K. Dosed by INR and weight.

CONTRAINDICATIONS

PATIENT EDUCATION

MY NOTES & MEMORY TRICKS

Albumin

Emergency & Rescue

GENERIC NAME

Albumin

BRAND NAME

DRUG CLASS

Colloid (Volume Expander)

DRUG FAMILY / SYSTEM

Emergency & Rescue

HIGH-ALERT MEDICATION

☐ Yes ☒ No

BOXED (BLACK BOX) WARNING

☐ Yes ☒ No

ROUTES (CHECK ALL THAT APPLY)

☐ PO ☐ IV ☐ IM ☐ SubQ ☐ SL ☐ Topical ☐ Inhaled ☐ Other

THERAPEUTIC USES

Hypovolemia, large-volume paracentesis, burns

MECHANISM OF ACTION

Raises oncotic pressure, holding fluid in vessels

ADVERSE / SIDE EFFECTS

Fluid overload, pulmonary edema

NURSING CONSIDERATIONS

5% for volume; 25% pulls fluid into vessels. Blood product: follow consent policy.

CONTRAINDICATIONS

PATIENT EDUCATION

MY NOTES & MEMORY TRICKS

Dextrose 50% (D50W)

Emergency & Rescue

GENERIC NAME	BRAND NAME	DRUG CLASS
Dextrose 50% (D50W)		Hypertonic Glucose
DRUG FAMILY / SYSTEM	HIGH-ALERT MEDICATION	BOXED (BLACK BOX) WARNING
Emergency & Rescue	☐ Yes ☒ No	☐ Yes ☒ No

ROUTES (CHECK ALL THAT APPLY)

☐ PO

☐ IV

☐ IM

☐ SubQ

☐ SL

☐ Topical

☐ Inhaled

☐ Other

THERAPEUTIC USES	NURSING CONSIDERATIONS
Severe hypoglycemia; with insulin for hyperkalemia	Use a large vein. Recheck glucose in 15 minutes.
MECHANISM OF ACTION	CONTRAINDICATIONS
Directly raises blood glucose	
ADVERSE / SIDE EFFECTS	PATIENT EDUCATION
Hyperglycemia, extravasation injury, phlebitis	

MY NOTES & MEMORY TRICKS

EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

NOT A CLINICAL REFERENCE

This study aid is a learning and exam-review tool for nursing and pharmacy students. It must not be used to make patient-care decisions, including dosing, administration, or monitoring.

ALWAYS VERIFY

Drug information, boxed (black box) warnings, and high-alert designations change over time. Before applying anything in practice, check the current FDA-approved labeling, your facility's policies, and an up-to-date drug reference. Normal lab ranges vary between laboratories; use the ranges your program or facility provides.

RECOMMENDED REFERENCES FOR VERIFICATION

- FDA drug labels: DailyMed (dailymed.nlm.nih.gov)
- ISMP List of High-Alert Medications ([ismp.org](https://www.ismp.org))
- A current nursing drug handbook or your program's required drug reference
- Your course textbook and instructor guidance

ACCURACY

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